

Ajay Venkatesh

Brooklyn, NY

+1 516 585 9013

av3855@nyu.edu

May 15, 2026

Hiring Manager

Affirm

Dear Hiring Manager,

My name is Ajay Venkatesh — finishing my M.S. in Computer Engineering at NYU, with several years of production software experience: a few years at PwC in Bengaluru, a summer SDE internship at Amazon, and ongoing on-campus work at NYU's Novel AI Technologies. My focus has been on **Python backend services, distributed systems on AWS**, and the patient end-to-end ownership that high-availability, customer-facing infrastructure actually demands.

The Identity Decisioning posting maps cleanly onto my work. At Amazon I architected a secure console for fulfillment center operators with role-based access enforced through **OAuth, Midway SSO, and HELIS** — exactly the kind of onboarding + authentication journey the team owns. I then built backend services that supported it: a high-throughput, event-driven incident triage system on **AWS ECS Fargate, SQS, SNS** that decoupled distributed message processing and materially reduced response latency, plus resilient **Infrastructure-as-Code** on **AWS CDK** (Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, IAM, CloudWatch) with multi-stage CI/CD and rollback controls. Designing for low-latency, high-availability under variable load — the posture identity decisioning needs — is the shape of work I've already been doing.

On the Python and distributed-systems side: **Python** is my daily driver for both backend services and ML pipelines, and I've shipped database-backed systems across **MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB**, and **DynamoDB**. I'm fluent in **Kubernetes** and **Docker** for orchestration, and comfortable navigating large codebases, debugging production incidents through logs, metrics, and traces, and providing feedback through code reviews. At PwC I led code reviews and mentored engineers on software design principles, materially reducing production defects.

On the fintech and customer-facing angle: at NYU's Novel AI Technologies I shipped an end-to-end insurance analytics platform — React, Node.js, REST APIs deployed via Docker on EC2, with Stripe billing, role-based access, and row-level security delivered to paying clients. The same posture — regulated workflows, sensitive identity data, careful trade-offs around UX vs. risk — carries over to consumer credit.

What pulls me toward Affirm specifically is the mission. "Honest credit, no hidden fees" isn't a slogan you can fake at the engineering layer — decisioning systems either treat people fairly or they don't, and the integrity of that pipeline lives in the code. That's an environment where engineering judgment compounds, and where the work actually changes how borrowers experience the product.

I'd welcome the chance to discuss further. Thanks for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Ajay Venkatesh